



TRAILDART

TRAIL DEVELOPMENT **A**SSISTANCE **R**ESPONSE **T**EAM

A Service of Rails-to-Trails Conservancy



SERVICES

PUBLIC INVOLVEMENT
CONCEPT PLANS
ALTERNATIVES ANALYSIS
TRAIL MANAGEMENT PLANS
CORRIDOR MAPPING

FEASIBILITY ANALYSIS
INVENTORY & ASSESSMENTS
TRAINING WORKSHOPS &
CONFERENCES

RESEARCH STUDIES & REPORTS
LEGAL REVIEWS

Front cover photos: Clockwise from top left: Hudson River Greenway, N.Y., Boyd Loving; Culver City, Calif., Rails-to-Trails Conservancy; Washington and Old Dominion, Va., Frederick G. Stork; Orange Heritage Trail, N.Y., Boyd Loving.

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TrailDART:

Trail Development, Assistance and Response Team

For 20 years, Rails-to-Trails Conservancy (RTC) has established itself as the leader of the United States Trails and Greenways Movement. Founded in 1986 as a national nonprofit 501(c)3 organization, it has more than 100,000 members and supporters, a national office in Washington, D.C., and regional offices in California, Florida, Massachusetts, Ohio and Pennsylvania. RTC's expert staff has helped hundreds of community-based organizations and federal, state and local government agencies build trails by supporting trail-friendly policy, advocating for increased funding, and educating communities on how to develop trails on underused rail corridors.

In response to the nation's rising demand for trails, RTC assembled the Trail Development, Assistance and Response Team (TrailDART) which provides trainings and specialized technical assistance to communities interested in building a trail. Supported by the resources of RTC, TrailDART has the experience and expertise to equip communities with the support they need to develop state-of-the-art trail systems. Our trail-building staff work as the primary contractor or sub-contractor to supply in-depth assistance on trail planning, design and implementation armed with the understanding of the unique processes involved when building trails on unused railroad corridors or next to active rail lines.

When your organization commissions the services of TrailDART, you gain immediate access to Rails-to-Trails Conservancy's extensive array of resources including training workshops, a robust database containing information on corridors, trails, and contacts, interactive mapping capabilities using Geographic Information Systems (GIS), and an expanding library of publications. All of these resources may be used to assist you with rail-trail planning and development



Washington and Old Dominion Trail, Virginia. (Frederick Stork)



TRAINING WORKSHOPS

RTC produces local, regional, state and national workshops that impart critical information to individuals and organizations working in trail, bicycle and pedestrian planning.

- ◆ **Trails and Greenways 101:** An introductory, one-day course for beginning trail builders focusing on benefits, ownership, railbanking, liability, crime, property values, design and maintenance.
- ◆ **Successful Strategies for Trail Development Workshops:** A comprehensive one-day trails advocacy course for the intermediate trail builder, providing resources and strategies for trail building. Recent workshops have been held in Helena, Montana; Burlington, Iowa; Red Top Mountain State Park, Georgia; Bloomington, Indiana; Fayetteville, Arkansas; and Albuquerque, New Mexico.

IN-HOUSE RESOURCES

- ◆ The **National Trails Database** is a central location that stores all rail-trail information. This vast collection is used to create best practices and summarize trail trends. Examples of information contained in our National Trails Database include:
 - Information on more than **1,300 open rail-trails** and **1,195 rail-trail projects**.
 - In-depth **trail descriptions and information** regarding surface types, endpoints, use restrictions, lengths, directions, maps, local trail group affiliates and regional resources.
 - Information on the **history of rail corridors**, including **abandonment filings** with the federal Surface Transportation Board.
 - **Contact information** for people in the trail community. These are the people who are working, or have worked, on the same types of projects as you.
- ◆ **GIS Mapping** capabilities allow us to map out your vision. We use our GIS abilities to help us analyze your particular project and are able to present you with a high-end product.
- ◆ Through a contract with the Federal Highway Administration, RTC coordinates the **National Transportation Enhancements Clearinghouse (NTEC)** which includes information and resources related to the federal Transportation Enhancements (TE) funding program. NTEC documents and can provide each state's specific TE application schedule and process, award limits, permitted applicants, Department of Transportation and Federal Highway Administration contacts, and other pertinent information needed to apply for a TE award. In addition, NTEC offers case studies of successful TE activities and projects, and includes the federal award amount, local matching funds, total project cost and a contact

person for each project, along with a detailed description of the project itself.

- ◆ **Research and Publications** are critical to RTC's work. Over the last 20 years we have produced dozens of publications focused on specific issues within the trail community, including liability, maintenance and community sentiments. Our staff consistently works to analyze the challenges and successes the community faces. We are abreast of trail issues and will research information that can be of use to you.



Farmington River Trail, Connecticut, in the design stage. (Eric Barz)

PROJECT PLANNING

TrailDART works independently and as a sub-contractor to private consulting firms to perform a variety of tasks associated with outreach, planning, design, research and project implementation. The team offers extensive planning experience, plus the support of the nation's largest trails organization. TrailDART makes a commitment to each community to create an atmosphere where trails can thrive.



TrailDART consultants in the field in Montana.

Services include:

- ◆ organizing and facilitating public meetings and community involvement
- ◆ presenting to and garnering support from elected officials and agency staff
- ◆ legal reviews of federal and state laws
- ◆ photo inventories
- ◆ land-use analysis
- ◆ GIS mapping
- ◆ inventory of local and state-level rail-trails
- ◆ national list of trail projects completed in conjunction with the railroad company in your area
- ◆ research of funding strategies with detailed information on Transportation Enhancement funding
- ◆ constraints and alternatives analyses
- ◆ assessment and feasibility studies
- ◆ concept, regional and master plans
- ◆ issue-specific research and publications

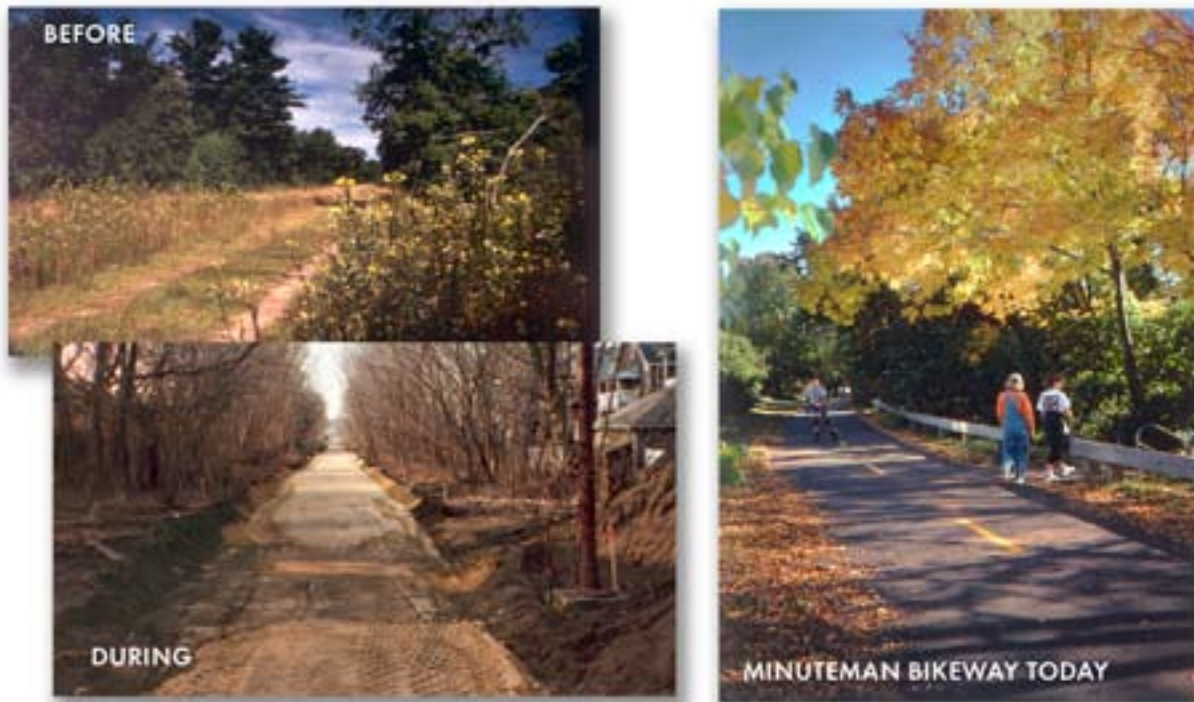
Each trail's transformation from abandoned rail corridor to neighborhood amenity follows a distinct path with unique challenges. Successful trails can provide a safe place for recreational activity, help connect communities to amenities and enhance neighborhoods. We look forward to helping you create trails and successfully achieve these goals.

PROJECT EXPERIENCE

TRAIL ASSESSMENT STUDIES

Assessment studies are the first step in the process toward creating a trail. They begin with an inventory of the corridor, focusing on land-use on or adjacent to the corridor, the basic integrity of structures on the trail (such as bridges or tunnels), the history of corridor disposition and current ownership. This, with community input, informs the optimal trail alignment. Assessments typically include a history

of the project and rail in the area, the outcome of community meetings, a detailed description of the site including GIS maps and satellite images, a list and description of concurrent studies, a legal review of state law and an overview of federal law pertaining to rail-trails. Funding information with detailed descriptions about Transportation Enhancements funding is also typically provided.



EXAMPLES OF TRAIL ASSESSMENTS:

Reconnecting Communities Phase II: Atlanta Rail Corridor Assessment: Moving from Assessment to Implementation — RTC in partnership with the city of Atlanta and key community leaders will take the results of the phase I assessment and coordinate community organizing and partnership outreach. Enhance the phase I assessment through in-depth project analysis. Facilitate meetings between city, Georgia transportation department, and affected railroads to structure a long-term alternative transportation agreement. Currently underway.

The Great American Rail -Trail: Milwaukee Road Montana Segment — With funding from the Wyss Foundation, RTC conducted an inventory and assessment of the Milwaukee Road corridor in Montana (approximately 375-miles), an essential link in the proposed coast to coast rail-trail. The study gathered critical information about the history of the abandonment, funding sources, pertinent contacts, included a legal review and other components to assist in the acquisition and construction of this project. 2004.

Coyote Creek Trail Final Alignment Plan and Report — RTC's California field office worked as a consultant to the City of San Jose's Department of Parks, Recreation and Neighborhood Services to engage residents to prepare an alignment plan for a 2.5-mile trail along Coyote Creek. The study's purpose was to engage both residents and technical experts to determine an alignment and associated features for the trail. The completed study has enabled the City to secure design and construction funding. 2004.

Statewide Rail ROW and Abandoned Corridors Evaluation Study — RTC's California field office was part of the project team conducting this study for the California Department of Transportation (Caltrans). They developed a comprehensive GIS database and evaluated the potential for joint use and reuse of existing and abandoned rail corridors for passenger rail, transit and non-motorized transportation, including rails-with-trails. The final product was made available to transportation agencies across



Schuylkill River Trail, Pennsylvania

the state to enable them to better map and evaluate potentials for corridor use, including factors such as connectivity to existing transit and bikeways, trip generating destinations, schools and major employment centers. 2005.

Florida Power & Light (FP&L) Pathway Assessment: Collier County — RTC, in partnership with the Collier County Pathways Task Force and the Department of Alternative Transportation Modes, assessed the trail potential of a four-mile FP&L utility corridor. The project included mapping, preliminary conceptual designs and community outreach. 2004.

Reconnecting Communities: Atlanta Rail Corridor Assessment Phase I — RTC produced an inventory and assessment of abandoned rail corridors in the Atlanta metro region for the Blank Foundation. The study inventoried and mapped all rail corridors abandoned between 1962 and 2003 in order to assess their potential for development as recreational trails, non-motorized transportation connectors or other public uses. The report was coordinated through an advisory committee of community leaders. 2004.

GreenWays Initiative: Planning for Detroit's Rail-Trails — RTC produced an inventory and assessment of abandoned rail corridors in the Detroit region for the Community Foundation for Southeastern Michigan, inventorying and mapping all rail corridors abandoned between 1962 and 2002. 2002.

Schuylkill County, Pennsylvania — RTC, in cooperation with the National Park Service, conducted a countywide assessment of potential greenways and rail-trails. 2001.



Proposed Cross Alameda Trail, California.

CONCEPT PLANS AND FEASIBILITY STUDIES

Concept Plans and Feasibility Studies create a vision for the project, determine feasibility and establish guidelines for project implementation. TrailDART staff work with community organizations and elected officials, through community meetings, workshops and training sessions, to create a vision for your project. Our expertise in rail-trail design and execution allows us to then establish a framework for project implementation, including sources and schedule of funding, and project management.

EXAMPLES OF CONCEPT PLANS:

Cross Alameda Trail Concept Plan — RTC's California field office, with funding from the San Francisco Foundation, developed a Vision Plan for an approximately three-mile trail across the island of Alameda. The plan engaged sectors of the city that were not typically involved in such plans and developed a constituency dedicated to bringing the concept to fruition. 2004

Hope to Springhill Trail Concept Plan — RTC prepared a concept plan for a 42-mile corridor in southeast Arkansas for the Melonvine Striders Running Club. We provided extensive information about the rail-to-trail conversion process; analysis of opportunities and constraints to trail development; planning, design and management recommendations; and public outreach. 2003.

Mission Creek Bikeway and Greenbelt Concept Plan — RTC worked in partnership with the San Francisco Bicycle Coalition and the Madrina Group to produce a concept plan for the creation of a bikeway and greenbelt through San Francisco's Mission and South of Market neighborhoods on a former railroad line. The concept plan provided extensive information about design and acquisition issues along specific segments of the corridor, proposed alternatives and involved extensive public participation. Completed for the Metropolitan Transportation Commission's TLC funding program. 2002.

Cedar Key Rail-Trail Concept Plan — RTC in cooperation with the National Park Service worked with local officials and citizens to develop a conceptual trail alignment between the small island community of Cedar Key and the traditional settlement of Rosewood, Florida. The team conducted a public workshop to seek input and to identify an alignment that ultimately consisted of significant portions of the long abandoned rail corridor as well as other public lands in the region. The portion of the trail in Cedar Key is now open. 2001.

Florida Keys Overseas Heritage Trail Concept Plan — RTC and Michael Design, Inc., developed a concept plan for the Florida Department of Environmental Protection for the first 20 miles of the 110-mile long trail that connects Key Largo to Key West utilizing the former Florida East Coast Railroad. 1999.

A Vision for Southeast Michigan Greenways — RTC in cooperation with the National Park Service, the Michigan Department of Natural Resources, and the University of Michigan School of Natural Resources and Environment, produced a report on a 10-year public planning process to develop a greenway vision for the Detroit metropolitan region. 1998.

Blountstown Greenway Concept Plan — RTC and the National Park Service prepared for the City of Blountstown, a concept plan for a five-mile trail within the Florida National Scenic Trail connecting numerous parks, schools and points of interest. 1996.

EXAMPLES OF FEASIBILITY STUDIES:

River Access & Interpretive/Welcome Center

Feasibility Study, Duncannon Borough — TrailD-ART working with BLOSS Associates, SEDA Council of Governments, Strauss and Associates, InSite Design, Inc., and the Pennsylvania Environmental Council is assessing the feasibility of developing connections between an existing trail system and a riverfront area planned for multi-purpose recreational and leisure activities. 2004–2005.

Hazleton to Eckley Trail Feasibility Study — RTC, working with Alfred Benesch & Company, prepared a study for a 4.2-mile section of the trail that will connect with a regional system in Pennsylvania. We determined the viability of the proposed preliminary routes; created a demand model for potential use of the trail; and reviewed trail operation, maintenance and financial feasibility. 2003.

New York High Line Feasibility Study — RTC, working with Friends of the High Line and primary consultant Hamilton, Rabinovitz & Alschuler, Inc., produced a feasibility study for submission to New York City. It included a legal analysis of railbanking and corridor acquisition as it pertains to the reuse of the line; cost estimates on urban rail-to-trail conversions, management practices and review of railroad acquisition requirements. 2002.

Sierra Pacific Rail-Trail, Preliminary Feasibility Study — RTC, with the Sierra Pacific Railroad, produced a preliminary feasibility study on conversion of a portion of the active railroad corridor to a rail-with-trail for the County of Tuolumne and the Tuolumne County Trails Council. 2001.

Hazleton Area Rail-Trail — RTC conducted a feasibility study in Pennsylvania of five different abandoned railroads in the greater City of Hazleton region. 2001.

Capital to Capital Bikeway Feasibility Study — RTC conducted a feasibility study of a corridor from Richmond to Williamsburg, Virginia, for the Virginia Department of Transportation. 1999.

Seacoast Area Planning Commission Feasibility Study

— RTC partnered with the commission studying the potential for resurrecting commuter rail to Portsmouth, New Hampshire. We presented resources and materials for a potential rail-with-trail component and examined the future potential for rail freight service on the line. 1998–1999.

Luzerne County Rail-with-Trail Study — RTC conducted the feasibility plan for this trail and was a subcontractor with Cultural Environmental Group, Inc., for preparation of this trail's master plan. The 11-mile trail will run near the Susquehanna River. 1998.



Highline Trail, New York City, New York.



Pinellas Trail, Florida. (Pinellas County Public Affairs)

MASTER PLANS AND REGIONAL PLANS

Rails-to-Trails Conservancy has worked with numerous municipalities as sub-consultants to produce transportation master plans. Our expertise in rail-trail conversions and rail-adjacent trail alignments strengthens any master plan which includes rail corridors.

EXAMPLES OF MASTER PLANS:

Collier County Pathways Master Plan — RTC's planning team worked with Sprinkle Consulting to conduct a comprehensive update to the County's previous plan. It analyzed both on-road and off-road facilities through use of the patented "Latent Demand" methodology to form an interconnected system of pathways throughout Collier County, Florida. 2005.

Pinellas Trail Florida Power Extension — RTC's planning team worked with Vanasse Hangen Brustlin, Inc., through a contract with Florida Power to plan and design a 29-mile extension to the popular Pinellas Trail near Tampa, Florida. 2001.

Florida Keys Overseas Heritage Trail Master Plan

— RTC and Michael Design, Inc. prepared for Monroe County a detailed design and implementation plan of a 110-mile corridor that connects Key Largo to Key West utilizing the former Florida East Coast Overseas Railroad. 2000.

Brodhead Greenway — RTC was a sub-consultant with Bloss Associates for the preparation of a feasibility study and master plan for the Brodhead Greenway in East Stroudsburg, Pennsylvania, which included public forums, physical inventory, trail operation, safety and liability. 1999.

Lebanon Valley Rail-Trail Master Plan — RTC assisted RBA, Inc. in the preparation of a master plan for this 12-mile rail-trail in Lebanon County, Pennsylvania including trail assessment, design, and maintenance. 1997.

The Cowboy Trail Master Plan — Through collaboration between RTC and Clark Enersen Partners, we prepared for the Nebraska Game and Parks Commission in cooperation with the U.S. Department of Transportation a master plan for the nation's longest rail-trail conversion (321 miles). 1997.

EXAMPLES OF REGIONAL PLANS:

Bicycle & Pedestrian Implementation Project

— RTC via a Pennsylvania Department of Transportation (PennDOT) contract assisted Gannett Fleming, Inc., in working with local Metropolitan Planning Organizations (MPO) to prepare specific regional plans as an outgrowth of the Commonwealth's statewide plan. 2000.

RAILS-WITH-TRAILS

Rails-with-Trails (trails adjacent to active rail lines) are increasing exponentially in communities across the U.S. As the desire to increase both public transportation and trails grows, more and more communities are looking to incorporate both rails and trails into the same transportation corridors. Rails-to-Trails Conservancy is at the forefront of this work.

To date, there are 115 rails-with-trails located in thirty-five states totaling 830 miles in length. Rails-to-Trails Conservancy is the only organization that keeps detailed records of these projects. Through the use of our database, we can easily find trails that share common traits with your trail.

We have also produced a number of reports and studies on Rails-with-Trails. In 1996 and again in 2000, RTC produced “Rails-with-Trails: Design, Management, and Operating Characteristics of Trails Along Active Rails Lines” which addresses safety issues, insurance and liability concerns, design and risk management, tools to working with railroads, and

an in-depth survey of managers of rails-with-trails. RTC also played a vital role in the U.S. Department of Transportation’s publication “Rails-with-Trails: Lessons Learned.” In addition, we recently compiled a report on at-grade crossings, an issue at the forefront of the rails-with-trails movement.

TrailDART has also been involved in numerous on the ground rails-with-trails studies, including:

- ◆ The St. Augustine Rails-with-Trails Assessment — RTC partnered with the engineering firm of VHB, Borrelli + Partners and Alta Consulting to conduct a feasibility study for the St. Johns County Parks and Recreation Department. The proposed trail segment is a 6-mile rail-with-trail from downtown St. Augustine. This trail brings the urbanized area of the nation’s oldest city into a larger regional trail system spanning 6 counties (101-miles long) as well as connects into the Cross-Florida Greenway. 2006
- ◆ Ludlam Trail Corridor Study, Miami, Fla. — RTC teamed up with RS&H to conduct a corridor study on the proposed 7-mile highly urbanized trail. It will connect Miami’s International Airport and MIC Station with other alternative mode





York County Heritage Rail-Trail, Pa. (Gwen Loose)

centers such as the Metro Rail, South Dade Busway, South Dade Rail Trail and the existing rails-with-trail project known as the M-Path. It also connects the large retail areas of Dadeland to surrounding neighborhoods and will serve as a safe route for two adjacent schools. Two of the three options detailed in the study included rail-with-trail. RTC was responsible for the acquisition recommendations and corridor valuation sections and facilitated meetings with executive staff of Florida East Coast Rail Road to ensure consensus and buy in at a corporate level. 2002

- ◆ Sierra Pacific Rail-Trail, Preliminary Feasibility Study, Calif. — RTC, with the Sierra Pacific Railroad, produced a preliminary feasibility study for Tuolumne County and Tuolumne County Trails Council on the conversion of an active railroad corridor to a rail-with-trail. 2001.
- ◆ Clarion-Little Toby Creek, Elk County, Pa. — RTC was hired to mediate a dispute between the railroad company and state as well as advise on specifications for an RFP. Segments of the rail-with-trail project run a few feet from an active line.
- ◆ Luzerne County Rail-with-Trail Study, Pa. — RTC conducted the feasibility plan for this trail and was a subcontractor with Cultural Environmental Group, Inc., for preparation of this trail's master plan. The 11-mile trail will run near the Susquehanna River. 1998.
- ◆ York County Heritage Rail-Trail, Pa. — RTC provided technical assistance in developing the Rail Trail Project Plan including examples of development costs from other rail-trail projects and a list of funding sources. An excursion dinner train ran on the adjacent rail line for a number of years and the rails are still actively used by motor car enthusiasts. The rail-with-trail project includes twelve at-grade crossings. 1988

SAFE ROUTES TO SCHOOL

Safe Routes to School programs are part of a national movement to get kids out of automobiles and back on their feet and their bikes by making school routes safer for pedestrians and bicyclists. Rails-to-Trails Conservancy's TrailDART has been involved in the Safe Routes to School program on many levels since its inception, from supporting the original national legislation to partnering on community projects.

Examples of our work includes:

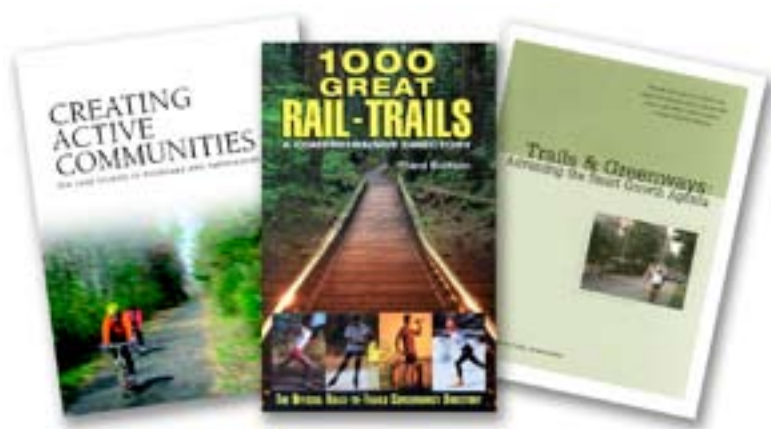
- ◆ Served on Florida Department of Transportation task force created to implement "Safe Paths to School" legislation.
- ◆ Served on Ohio's first official Ohio State Safe Routes to School Committee, advising and consulting Ohio State Government on Safe Routes to School activities.
- ◆ Advocated for the first California Safe Routes to School bill and is one of five statewide organizations invited annually to participate on CALTRANS selection committee.
- ◆ Completed a walkability assessment of the Brockway, Pennsylvania community; identified key walking routes and issues; helped the community obtain additional state and federal funding (funded through the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention through the Pennsylvania Department of Health).
- ◆ Served on project team with Pennsylvania Department of Health, for Center for Disease Control (CDC) funded pilot "Walk-To-School Program" using a rail-trail as the spine of a pedestrian system.
- ◆ Conducted a parent survey and teacher survey, a "mapping" session, and other exercises for school in Columbus, Ohio as part of its Safe Routes to School Program with the intent that it becomes a pilot for replication throughout the state of Ohio.
- ◆ Conducted statewide training workshops in Pennsylvania at interested schools to help schools prepare Safe Routes to School funding applications. 2004.
- ◆ Coordinated a "Safe Ways/Safe Paths to School Workshop" in Florida supported by Florida Legislature and Florida Department of Transportation, featuring panelists from state agencies, Metropolitan Planning Organizations, law enforcement and school administrators, attended by government officials, school officials and parents. 2003.



DR Canal State Park Trail, New Jersey. (Boyd Loving)

RESEARCH AND PUBLICATIONS

Rails-to-Trails Conservancy produces a variety of publications and also partners with other organizations and consulting firms to complete research documents. These include, but are not limited to:



Rail-Trail Maintenance & Operation: Ensuring the Future of Your Trail — A Survey of 100 Rail-Trails — RTC's Northeast Regional produced this report which documents maintenance practices, issues, and costs for 100 rail-trails, primarily in the northeast United States. Information is provided about trail ownership, maintenance responsibility and cost, liability, the maintenance of trail surfaces, vegetation, structures, and amenities. Maintenance tips are presented along with sample schedules and budgets. 2005.

Creating Active Communities — A collection of case studies providing examples of how organizations across the nation are encouraging individuals to stay physically active by implementing community programs that promote walking and cycling. Written and published by RTC, funded by Robert Wood Johnson Foundation, Active Living by Design. 2004.

Trails and Greenways: Strategies for Regional Planning and Implementation — Written and published by RTC. 2004.

1000 Great Rail-Trails — A comprehensive directory of rail-trails throughout the country. Produced by RTC and The Globe Pequot Press. Third Edition. 2004.

Enhancing America's Communities: A Guide to Transportation Enhancements — Written and published by RTC with the National Transportation Enhancements Clearinghouse and the Federal Highway Administration in 1999. Revised and updated, 2002.

Trails and Greenways: Advancing the Smart Growth Agenda — Highlights how trails and greenways promote smart growth objectives, such as preserving open space, reducing sprawl and connecting communities. Written and published by RTC. 2002.

Florida Parks Service Trails Standards, Operations and Procedures Manual — Written in cooperation with the Florida Department of Environmental Protection, RTC developed trail standards and management practices for Florida State Parks. 2001.

Trails for the Twenty-First Century: Planning, Design and Management Manual for Multi-Use Trails — RTC's comprehensive manual on the planning, design and management of multi-use trails. Island Press, 1993. Revised and updated, 2001.

Tunnels and Trails: A Survey of Engineering, Funding, and Community Impacts of Tunnels on Bike Trails — Five case studies of trail tunnels across the country highlighting planning and design elements. Commissioned by Marin County, California. 2001.

Rail-Trails and Liability: A Primer on Trail-Related Liability Issues and Risk Management Techniques —Addresses trail liability concerns and offers risk management strategies for trail managers and adjacent landowners. Written and published by RTC with the National Park Service. 2000.

Rails-With-Trails: Sharing Corridors for Transportation and Recreation — Provides an overview of successful trails that run parallel to active rail lines, outlining the benefits, design and management strategies for safety, approaches to working with railroads, and the survey results of 61 rails-with-trails managers. Written and published by RTC with the National Park Service. 2000.

Rail-Trails and Safe Communities: The Experience on 372 Trails —Substantiates the safety of rail-trails by documenting crime levels on urban, suburban and rural rail-trails. Includes design and management strategies. Written and published with the National Park Service. 1998.

The Road to a Cleaner Environment: How to Use Highway Funds to Enhance Water Quality, Wetlands and Habitat Connections — This Southern California case study and draft guidebook for public agencies, public/private industry partnerships and nonprofit organizations/public agency partnerships was written and published by RTC and The Claremont Graduate University Research Institute for U.S. EPA (Region IX) and the Los Angeles Regional Water Quality Control Board. 1998.

Rail-Trails and Community Sentiment: A Study of Opposition to Rails-Trails and Strategies for Success — Explores the sources of trail opposition from within a community and gives strategies for successfully overcoming such opposition. Written and published by RTC with the National Park Service. 1997.

Acquiring Rail Corridors: A How-to Manual — Outlines a plan of action for acquiring railroad corridors, including researching the property, negotiating with the railroad and funding the acquisition. Written and published by RTC with the National Park Service. 1996.

Secrets of Successful Rail-Trails: An Acquisition and Organizing Manual for Converting Rails into Trails — Ideal for citizen organizations and government agencies, this manual outlines the organizational techniques and technical information needed to convert abandoned railroad corridors into rail-trails. Written and published by RTC with the National Park Service. 1993.

Abandoned Rail Corridor Assessment Reports — RTC corridor assessments conducted in the San Francisco Bay Area (1990), the Los Angeles Metropolitan Area (1994), Atlanta, Philadelphia, Boston, Chicago, and the Puget Sound Metropolitan Area (1988–1991).

Railroads Recycled: How Local Initiative and Federal Support Launched the Rails-to-Trails Movement — 1965–1990.



THE PLANNING TEAM RESUMES



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Professional Experience

Vice President of Trail Development

Rails-to-Trails Conservancy, Washington, D.C.

Oversees the organizations' trail building programmatic services. Implements RTC's regional expansion throughout the US. Provides extensive training

and education for the trails movement. Presents at national and international venues. Consults on trail projects in communities throughout the US. Builds partnerships and facilitates cooperation with organizations and agencies to promote the development of trail and greenway systems.

Director of Trail Development 2001–2004

Rails-to-Trails Conservancy, Washington, D.C.

Managed TrailDART operations. Planning team duties include project management, community outreach, trail assessment, on-site consultation, trail design recommendations and management analysis and report writing. Oversaw national technical assistance program. Responsible for providing technical assistance, training and grassroots organizing. Represented RTC at trail meetings and state and local government hearings.

Trails Implementation Manager 2000–2001

Rails-to-Trails Conservancy, Washington, D.C.

Senior Program Manager 1998–2000

Florida Field Office, Rails-to-Trails Conservancy, Tallahassee, Florida

Education

Bachelor of Arts, Rollins College, Winterpark, Florida

Post-Baccalaureate coursework in Public Administration, Florida State University, Tallahassee, Florida

Professional Memberships & Affiliations

Association of Pedestrian and Bicycle Professionals, East Coast Greenway Alliance, Federal Interagency Council on Trails, National Trails Training Partnership, European Greenway Alliance, Washington Area Bicycle Association, American Red Cross

Presentations/Publications

Successful Strategies for Trail Development in Albuquerque, N.M.; Fayetteville, Ark.; Bloomington, Ind.; Providence, R.I.; Atlanta, Ga.; Helena, Mont.; Minneapolis/St. Paul, Minn.; Denver, Colo.; TrailDART Projects in The Great American Rail-Trail: Milwaukee Road Segment, Montana and Idaho (2004–5); Atlanta Rail Corridor Assessment Phase I and II (2004–5); Florida Power and Light Greenway, a Shared-Use Corridor Pilot Project (2004); Understanding Environmental Contaminants: Lessons Learned and Guidance to Keep Your Rail-Trail Project on Track (2004); Greenways Initiative: Planning for Detroit's Rail-Trails (2002); Hope to Springhill Trail Concept Plan (2003); Florida Keys Overseas Heritage Trail — Master Plan (2000).

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Professional Experience

Director, Florida Field Office
Rails-to-Trails Conservancy, Tallahassee, Florida
Provides technical assistance and consulting services to state and local governments for planning, developing and managing trails and greenways. Oversees

acquisition of lands to be converted for trail use. Responsible for advocating select legislation and program funding, and representing pro-trail interests during agency rule-making procedures. Facilitates and participates in public workshops, conferences and speaking platforms.

Program Coordinator 1990–1992

Clay County Board of County Commissioners, Green Cove Springs, Florida

Co-founded Clay Council on Physical Fitness and Sports. Assisted in writing recreation and open space element of Comprehensive Plan. Active in park planning and management activities for the Parks and Recreation department. Co-founded Keep Clay Beautiful, Inc., and represented the commission on County Bicycle and Pedestrian Advisory Committee. Co-founded Northeast Florida Associated Trails, Inc.

Education

Bachelor of Science, University of Florida, Gainesville, Florida
Post-Baccalaureate coursework in Public Administration, Florida State University, Tallahassee, Florida

Professional Memberships & Affiliations

Greenways and Trails Council (Chairman 2003–Present, Vice-Chairman 2000), Florida Department of Transportation Central Office's Bicycle/Pedestrian Advisory Committee (2005–Present), Florida Bicycle Association Advisory Board (2002–Present), Environmental Fund for Florida, Inc. (Past Board and Executive Committee member), Florida Department of Environmental Protection Recreational Trails Council (1996–2000), Tallahassee/Leon County Planning Commission (ex-officio member 1998), Tallahassee/Leon County Transportation Planning Advisory Committee (Vice-Chairman 1996, Chairman 1997)

Presentations/Publications

Contributing author to: Rosewood-Cedar Key Rail-Trail Concept Plan (2001), Florida Keys Overseas Heritage Trail Master Plan (2000), Florida Keys Overseas Heritage Trail Concept Plan (1998), Florida Recreational Trails Standards (1998), Pinellas Trail Florida Power Extension (2001), Ludlam Trail Corridor Study (2002), Paynes Creek Greenway Concept Plan (2005), Blountstown Greenway Concept Plan (1996), Gopher, Frog and Alligator PD&E Study (1996), Sierra Pacific Railtrail, Preliminary Feasibility Study (2001), Florida Power & Light Pathway Assessment (2004), Florida Park Service Trail Standards and Procedures Manual (2001).

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Professional Experience

Director, Western Region
Rails-to-Trails Conservancy, Western Regional Office, San Francisco, California
Responsible for overall management and operations of the California field office and for overseeing implementation of all aspects of technical as-

sistance on rail-trail conversions for transportation development professionals and affiliated public and private trail organizations and transportation agencies. Primary responsibility for policy, legislative and advocacy activities as they relate to nonmotorized transportation and trail and greenway development in California. Regularly facilitates and conducts presentations on a variety of nonmotorized transportation and trail planning and development issues (planning, design, management, funding, policy issues and liability) at board, commission and council meetings, as well as conferences and public workshops. Current projects include helping develop a comprehensive GIS database of active and abandoned rail corridors and analyzing their potential for non-motorized use as part of a Statewide Rail Corridor Survey & Assessment for Caltrans.

Deputy Chief of Staff 1991–1994

California Legislature, Office of Sen. Tom Hayden
Managed the Los Angeles District Office for the 23rd Senate District. Legislative work was concentrated on land use, transportation and environmental issues and projects in the 23rd District, which included portions of Los Angeles, the San Fernando Valley, and the coastal areas along the Santa Monica Bay.

Senior Counsel 1987–1991

MGM/UA, Los Angeles, California

Legal practice as in-house counsel for MGM/UA on matters relating to contracts, intellectual property, labor relations and copyright issues.

Education

Juris Doctor, Boalt Hall School of Law, University of California, Berkeley, California

Bachelor of Arts, University of California, Santa Barbara, California

Professional Memberships & Affiliations

California Alliance for Transportation Choices (Steering Committee), Caltrans Alternative Transportation and Livable Communities working group (Founding Member), California State Bar, California Transportation Commission to the State Transportation Enhancements (Advisory Committee).

**THOMAS P. SEXTON**

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Professional Experience

Director, Northeast Region
 Rails-to-Trails Conservancy, Northeast
 Regional Office, Camp Hill, Pennsylvania
 Responsible for overall management
 and operations of RTC's Northeast
 Regional office, covering 10 states, and
 for all aspects of technical assistance to

trail organizations and municipalities in the northeastern United States. Coordinates trail development in cooperation with community leaders, local governments and state agencies. Oversaw Pennsylvania Department of Health contract to develop a rural walk-to-school program that has been expanded to include funding for local rail-trails project. As co-chair of Pennsylvanian Advocates for Nutrition and Activity (PANA), helps implement the state's obesity plan by coordinating with health professionals to promote physical activity and community design. Contributed to several trail master plans and co-chaired RTC's 1999 international trails and greenways conference. Founder of the annual Pennsylvania Sojourn Ride. Supervises a staff of five.

Executive Director 1986–1991

Chesapeake Bay Foundation, Harrisburg, Pa.

Established and was responsible for overall management and operation of CBF's Pennsylvania office which grew to nine full-time staff, including scientific, legal and educational personnel.

Senior Staff Member 1984–1986

United States House of Representatives, Washington, D.C.

Managed constituent correspondence system.

Recreation Resource Planner 1983

National Park Service, Mid-Atlantic Region, Philadelphia, Pa.

Provided technical assistance to municipalities and analyzed land use techniques for the Schuylkill River Greenway Plan.

Island Manager 1982

Massachusetts Department of Environmental Resources, Boston, Mass.

Managed Lovell's Island, part of Boston Harbor Island State Park.

Naturalist 1979–1981

Wildcliff Museum, New Rochelle, N.Y.

Designed, marketed and taught natural history and outdoor recreation programs at the museum, in schools, and in the field.

Education

Masters in Regional Planning, University of Mass., Amherst, Mass.

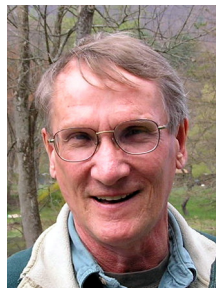
Bachelors of Arts and Science, East Stroudsburg University, East Stroudsburg, Pennsylvania

Professional Memberships & Affiliations

Environmental Fund for Pennsylvania (Founder); Pennsylvania Conservation and Natural Resources Advisory Council; Pennsylvania Greenway Partnership Commission (Chair of Plan Development Committee); Pennsylvania Transportation Enhancement Advisory Committee

Presentations/Publications

Author of *Pennsylvania's Rail-Trails*, *Bicycling Directory of Pennsylvania* (2002) and co-author of *40 Rail-Trails of New York* (2002). Co-host of GreenWorks, television show (2000–02).

**CARL R. KNOCH**

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Professional Experience**Manager of Trail Development,**

Northeast Region

Rails-To-Trails Conservancy, Northeast
 Regional Office, Camp Hill, Pennsylvania

Provides technical assistance and consulting services to state and local governments and advocacy organizations

regarding the planning, development and management of trails and greenways based upon more than eight years of hands on trail development experience. Facilitates and participates in public workshops, conferences and speaking engagements.

Consultant 2003–2006

Trail Facts, New Freedom, Pa.

Conducted trail research studies, developed economic impact analysis and assisted organizations with the development of trail projects. Trail development—Heritage Rail Trail (HRT), Northern Extension HRT, Hanover Trolley Trail. Feasibility studies—Tinicum-Fort Mifflin Trail, Snyder County Trail. User and economic impact studies—HRT, Northern Central Rail Trail, Pennsylvania Greenway Sojourn, Upper Chesapeake Trail.

Consultant 1996–2002

Interactive Marketing Solutions, New Freedom, Pennsylvania

Developed business and marketing plans for consumer companies.

Marketing and Research Manager 1989–1996

Research and software firms in Alexandria, Va. and Hunt Valley, Md.

Managed surveys, staff, budgets, and sales forecasts.

Marketing Manager 1973–1988

Financial services firms in Harrisburg, Pa. and Baltimore, Md.

Implemented electronic banking services and managed development of new products.

Account Executive 1969–1973

Advertising agencies in York, Pa. and Baltimore, Md.

Implemented advertising strategies.

Education

Masters of Administration, Pennsylvania State University, Middletown, Pennsylvania

Bachelors of Science, Pennsylvania State University, University Park, Pennsylvania

Professional Memberships & Affiliations

York County (Pa.) Rail Trail Authority—Chairman; Pennsylvania Recreation and Park Society

Presentations/Publications

Projecting Trail Usage Demand and Economic Impact (Pa. Recreation and Park Society (PRPS) Greenway and Trail Summit 2006), Quantifying The Benefits of Trails and Greenways (Rails-to-Trails Conservancy TrailLink 2005), The Economic Impact of Trails (PRPS Greenway and Trail Summit 2005), The Economic Impact of Cyclists (National Bike Symposium 2005), The Benefits of Trails and Greenways: A Quantitative Perspective (American Trails National Trails Symposium 2004), How to Use Trail Surveys and Economic Impact Analysis (Rails-to-Trails Conservancy International TrailLink Conference 2003).



PATRICIA TOMES
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Professional Experience

Program Coordinator, Northeast Region, Rails-to-Trails Conservancy, Northeast Regional Office, Camp Hill, Pennsylvania
Provide technical assistance to state and local governments and advocacy organizations on planning, design, development and management of trails

and greenways. Build and maintain collaborative and strategic relationships with other transportation, recreation, conservation and community based organizations. Write and manage grant applications to and serve as liaison with State agencies. Program coordinator for the annual Pennsylvania Greenways Sojourn Ride. Project manager for the publication: *Pennsylvania's Rail-Trails*, a guidebook of open rail-trails in Pennsylvania. Author and edit trail descriptions, generate maps and photography, manage the design, layout and printing of the final publication.

Administrative Assistant 2001–2002

Rails-to-Trails Conservancy, Pennsylvania

Maintain and organize trail records and computer databases, respond to office e-mail, process accounting records for National Office. Prepare mailing and newsletters for general membership and trail contacts. Provide general technical assistance to phone and e-mail inquiries, assist with preparation of contracts and maintain registration for the Pennsylvania Greenway Sojourn.

Curator and Museum Collections Manager 1984–1998

The National Watch and Clock Museum, Columbia, Pennsylvania
Collections and data management, research and exhibit development, membership support and long-range planning. Consultant for horological collections and exhibitions at other institutions including the National Park Service, The National Geographic Society and the U.S. State Department.

Education

Bachelor of Fine Arts, Edinboro University, Edinboro, Pennsylvania
Graduate Studies in Art History and Metalsmithing, Indiana University, Indiana, Pennsylvania

Professional Memberships & Affiliations

PA-DCNR Secretary's Greenway Advisory Committee; Committee member: Susquehanna Greenway, Mainline Canal Greenway; Secretary's Workgroup on Economic Impact of Rail-Trails.

Presentations/Publications

Pennsylvania's Rail-Trails, Editor 8th, 9th, 10th editions 2002–2005;
Economic Impact of Rail-Trails (Pennsylvania Greenways and Trails Summit, 2005). Eco-Tourism: The Greenway Sojourn (*TrailLink* 2005, Minneapolis, Minn.)



ERIC OBERG
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Professional Experience

Manager of Trail Development, Midwest Region, Rails-to-Trails Conservancy, Midwest Regional Office, Canal Winchester, Ohio
Responsible for the delivery of all levels of trail development technical assistance in the Midwest region, including

managing technical assistance contracts, products, and services. Assists local communities with trail planning and development through a variety of strategies including: research, preparation, and dissemination of resource materials such as fact sheets and studies; organizing and conducting public meetings and workshops and developing local trail advocacy networks; educating and training regional constituents; preparing planning documents and performing project consulting work; and assisting regional and national staff in developing grants and contracts to fund in-depth technical assistance.

Trail Crew Leader 2000–2007

National Park Service Denali National Park and Preserve, Denali Park, Alaska

Performed all aspects of trail system development, from concept plan, to surveying, to construction and maintenance. Designed and built trails in non-motorized wilderness areas. Constructed multi-use paths using both hand tools and heavy equipment. Built numerous projects from staircases to retaining walls and drainage structures using dry stone masonry infrastructure. Managed and built multiple bridge projects, including surveying, construction and pouring of abutments. Performed woodworking projects using advanced joinery skills on natural logs. Digitized entire trail system into GIS. Developed safety training and certification program for trail staff.

Board Member 2005–2007

Denali Citizens Council, Denali, Alaska

Extensive community outreach and organizing work. Successfully lobbied governmental on behalf of membership. Assisted with the organization of multi-day community "summits" that facilitated dialog on long term planning and development issues. Regularly published articles in the organizational newsletter on topics ranging from political events to community affairs. Represented organization at numerous political functions, providing testimony on our membership's behalf at both the local and state level. Served as co-president of the board.

**Rails-to-Trails Conservancy**

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